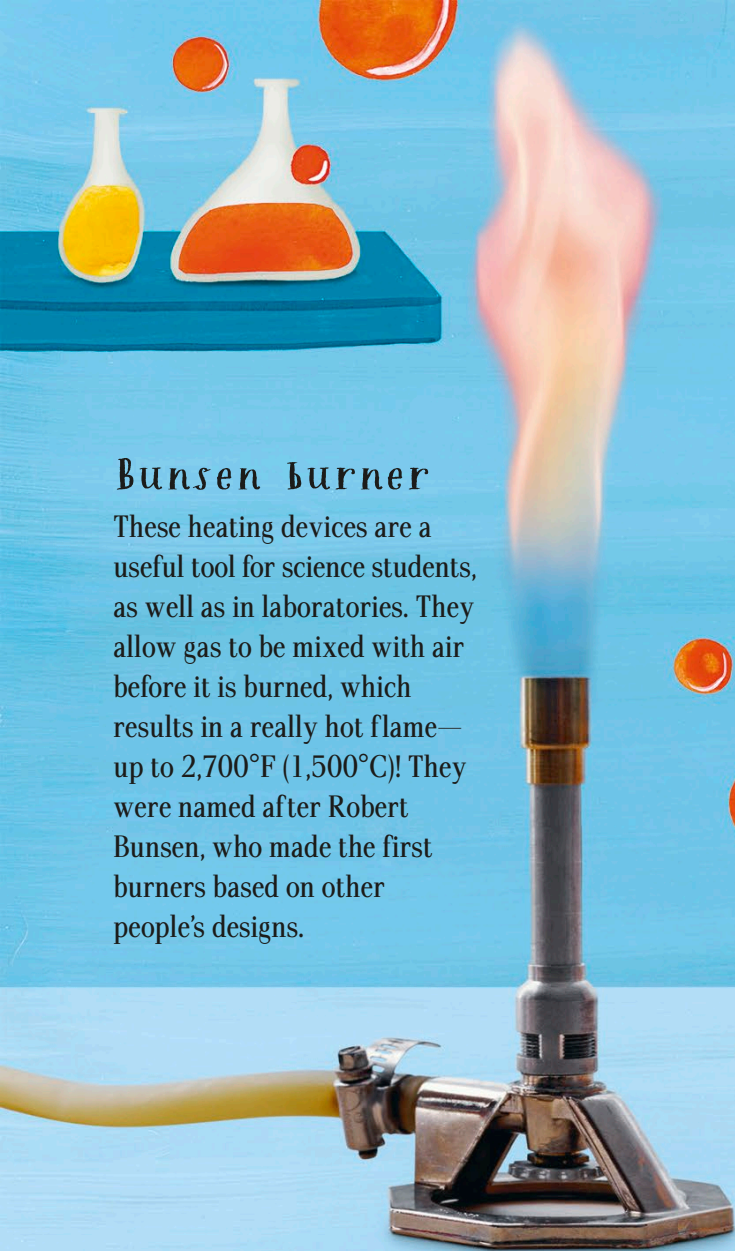


LAB TOOLS

Bunsen burner

These heating devices are a useful tool for science students, as well as in laboratories. They allow gas to be mixed with air before it is burned, which results in a really hot flame—up to 2,700°F (1,500°C)! They were named after Robert Bunsen, who made the first burners based on other people's designs.



Science begins with observation, and for this, we rely on our senses—sight, hearing, smell, touch, and even taste. Over hundreds of years, scientists have designed a range of tools and instruments to help them control, explore, and measure the world beyond these senses. In turn, these tools and instruments have shaped science itself.



Heatproof glass

Glass containers were first used more than 2,000 years ago. Glass doesn't often react to strong chemicals and it is transparent, so you can see experiments as they happen. Today, these containers are usually made with boron oxide, and are called borosilicate glass. This added substance helps glass cope with high temperatures without cracking.



The first pipettes were made from glass tubes with rubber bulbs, but today they are often formed from a single piece of plastic.

Pasteur pipette

Louis Pasteur invented these droppers to move tiny amounts of liquids and microscopic germs from place to place, without mixing them with other things. Squeezing the bulb at the end forces air or liquid out, while releasing it sucks air or liquid up into the tube.



Plastic pipette